A first response to change teacher and cover plan

GROW Spring 1 Week 1 Wednesday 6 January 2027 P5 Year A Explore

Teach one 40 minute lesson. Both pathways use Explore. Explore how artists express resilience and change.

Today: I can develop my first response, test a change and record how an artist's idea helped me.

Success criteria

I make or direct an original response to resilience or change.

I test one adjustment and describe its effect.

I add evidence and a personal view to my arts log.

Prepare before pupils arrive

For five pupils: five books or arts logs, five pencils and ten small test sheets if available.

Optional visual route: five sheets, six brushes including the adult model, a small amount of familiar non-toxic paint, five mats, three stable water pots and cloths.

Optional collage route: ten scrap sheets and three glue sticks. Tear paper instead of cutting; no pins.

Movement, original words or quiet finger taps need no art materials. A pupil may direct the adult.

Keep the original work or a dated observation note and the pupil's confirmed words for lesson two.

Set a clear stop signal and quiet option. Offer an invented feeling or abstract theme. Have the prior work or an honest catch-up trial ready for lesson two.

Timing

Arrival 0-3; Starter 3-6; I do 6-12; We do 12-18; Create 18-32; Review 32-37; Exit 37-40 minutes. Tidy in the final two minutes of Review.

Non specialist demonstration

0-15 seconds: Say: I want to show a seed growing after wind. Make four small grey zigzag marks, or four small sideways hand movements.

15-30 seconds: Say: I will repeat the movement, then change it. Add three green curves that grow taller, or move the hands slowly upwards.

30-45 seconds: Say: My last marks point up. That change suggests growth to me. Leave a pause and compare the first and last part.

45-60 seconds: Say: I can test another spacing or pace. I will choose the version that best fits my idea. This is our original example, not a copy of an artwork.

Teaching the first twelve minutes

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Arrival 0 to 3 minutes

Pupil task: Recall your first response. You may keep the art form or change your method.

What to say: Last time you tried an idea. You may keep that form or change your method. Let us check the quiet option and stop signal before we begin.

What good looks like: The pupil recognises a previous choice or chooses a manageable restart.

Materials free fallback: Adult reads the ordered note. Pupil repeats or directs the previous gesture or spoken sequence.

Starter 3 to 6 minutes

Pupil task: Recall one detail about Matisse and one about Thomas. Listen to the cards again if needed.

What to say: Which artist tested arrangements of cut shapes? Which artist used repeated coloured marks? You can listen to the cards again.

What good looks like: The pupil identifies an artist feature, with rereading if needed.

Materials free fallback: Use the spoken cards and two verbal choices. Point to a numbered choice or answer orally.

I do 6 to 12 minutes

Pupil task: Watch one change to the original seed example. What changed? Why?

What to say: My first marks all point sideways. I want growth to be clearer, so I change the last marks to point up. I keep the first part. This is my interpretation of resilience. The artists helped me think about a method, but this design is my own.

What good looks like: The pupil notices a specific before-and-after change and hears a reason linked to the idea.

Materials free fallback: Use the same seated gesture sequence, changing only its final direction. Describe it if movement is uncomfortable.

Check and response: Did I change a feature for a reason, or only add more? Expected: changed the final direction to suggest growth.

Guided practice and making

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We do 12 to 18 minutes

Pupil task: Try two versions of one feature. Ask what your partner notices. Hinge: must you use feedback, ignore it, or consider it and choose for your purpose?

What to say: Let us try both versions. Tell me what you notice before suggesting a change. You can say 'The second version seems ... because ...'. The artist chooses what to keep. A listener says, 'The slow ending feels steady to me.' Must the artist A use that opinion, B ignore it, or C consider it and choose a change for their own purpose? Explain.

What good looks like: The pupil compares two versions and hears feedback linked to a visible or audible feature. They retain control of the choice. The pupil selects C and explains that feedback helps a decision but does not remove their choice.

Materials free fallback: Perform two quiet or silent versions. The adult describes observed pace, spacing or direction without judging personal feelings. Choose from the spoken options and say or indicate one feature to test.

Check and response: If the pupil selects A or B without a reason, model two different interpretations and reread the purpose. Parallel hinge: 'Two people read blue differently. Can the artist keep blue and explain their intention?' Expected: yes. Move on when the pupil chooses a feature for a reason.

Create 18 to 32 minutes

Pupil task: Develop your own response. Test one change. Choose the version to keep. Use a quiet or silent route if you prefer. You may pause or ask for help.

What to say: Make the response manageable. Use repetition or rearrangement in your own way. Keep the first version in a note or memory cue, test one change, then decide what to keep.

What good looks like: The pupil creates or directs a short original response and makes one purposeful adjustment. Art form may change when it improves access or suits the idea.

Materials free fallback: Use a silent gesture, short drama sequence, original sound pattern or spoken piece. Adult observes before and after and records the exact ordered actions and pupil's reason.

Optional progression evidence

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Optional next level stretch

What to say: If you want the extra task, Set one skill goal. Keep a note of your first try. Practise that skill. Try your piece again. Compare the two versions. Say how an artist's method helped. What feedback did you use? Choose your next practice step.

What good looks like: The pupil identifies how practising one skill changed the response and evaluates the change against their own intention rather than simply saying it is better.

Materials free fallback: Adult observes both live versions and records the ordered actions with the pupil's explanation. Audio, image and written pupil work are not required.

Retain: Keep your goal, both versions or a witness note, and your views. Add your artist link, feedback used and next step.

This retains additional evidence for possible future progression. It does not change the lesson level or make the Explore work dependent on stretch completion.

Review and evidence

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Review 32 to 37 minutes

Pupil task: Explain the artist link and your own choices. Record your change and its effect in the arts log.

What to say: What idea did you borrow from an artist's method? What did you make yourself? Which change helped, and how do you know? You can explain that different viewers may read it differently.

What good looks like: The pupil identifies a genuine artist link, describes their own choice and evaluates a specific adjustment.

Materials free fallback: Adult records a brief dated oral log. Separate the pupil's stated intention from the adult's observation.

Exit 37 to 40 minutes

Pupil task: Choose one next step. Keep your response and log evidence together.

What to say: What did you learn about making art through change? Choose one next step, such as more practice, a different material or asking for feedback. You can be satisfied with a small response today.

What good looks like: The pupil gives a specific next step. The retained record shows participation, exploration and a view of their own work.

Materials free fallback: Say the next step while the adult repeats it back and records it with the observed response.

Store and log

Use the final two minutes of Review for quiet tidy-up. Keep paintings flat to dry, cap wet materials and wipe mats. Sound and movement pupils retain a simple sequence plan or dated adult observation plus their words. Work-only images are optional. Store the actual first attempt and log together.

Cover teacher route

Recover the previous response from the work or adult note. Model one change to the seed example. Pupils test a single adjustment, choose what to keep and log the artist link and effect. Accept silent or spoken work and private sharing. Optional stretch can be omitted. Reserve the final two minutes of Review for quiet tidy-up and safe storage. If the previous response is missing, make a fresh short trial and record today's actual date.

Access and teaching decisions

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Adaptations and prompt ladder

Cognition and Learning: Show one instruction at a time. Model a small test, offer two choices, then fade the prompt. Read the artist description aloud when needed.

Communication and Interaction: Allow pointing, signing, speech or an adult scribe. Give processing time. Use I chose ___ because ___. Read scribed words back for correction.

SEMH: Use a fictional feeling or abstract idea. Let pupils choose form and audience. Offer a calm pause and agreed return cue. Public performance and personal disclosure are optional.

Sensory and Physical: Offer silent seated movements, large marks and pupil-directed adult handling. Keep sound below talking volume. Stop on a raised hand. Ask before touching work.

EAL: Plan in any language. Teach words through marks and gestures. Accept a labelled sketch or oral explanation. Check meaning before spelling.

1. Point to the place or instruction.
2. Ask a short question.
3. Rephrase the instruction.
4. Provide a scaffold or choice.
5. Model the first step only, then return the task.

Common mistakes and fixes

Everyone reads a colour or sound in the same way. - Colours and sounds can suggest different feelings to different people. A reasoned personal reading is valid.

Resilience means doing the same thing until it works. - An artist can change a method, take a break or ask for help. A purposeful adjustment counts.

A response must copy the artist's work. - Borrow an idea such as repetition or rearrangement, then make your own subject and design. Do not recreate an existing composition.

We know an artist's feelings just by describing a work. - Separate verified information from interpretation. Say 'This suggests ... to me' rather than claiming to know a private feeling.

Feedback

Give one specific success and one next step. VF verbal feedback; WS worked with support; I independent; NS next step; // self-edit; ? read this back; E evidence retained; R responded. Use R only when pupil voice and an audience are present, one NS is set, and the pupil responds in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode. A saved image alone is not R.

Where this leads

Artists, designers and performers test ideas and explain their choices. These skills help when working to a brief.